

When nervous city fathers gathered to surrender the city to the Union, they had to scramble to find carriages, most having been stolen by Wheeler's vacating cavalry. Many citizens were frantic that their city would go the same way as Atlanta. But when Sherman rode in on December 22, he found the same town of handsome squares and shade trees that he remembered so fondly. As his tattered legions marched down the grand avenues, he sent a telegram to President Lincoln: "Dear Sir," he began, "I beg to present you as a Christmas Gift, the City of Savannah ..."



Haul of ammunition

The capture of Fort McCallister outside Savannah, which had long been a menace to Union warships, brought with it a sizable haul of guns, shells, and cannonballs.